NEW ZEALAND · VALUES AND LANGUAGE

The Kiwi Identity

More than rugby and hobbits: explore the values, language, and “can-do” attitude associated with New Zealanders.



What do you think of when you hear “New Zealand”?

Start with your first associations.

- Look at the kiwi bird, rugby, and Hobbiton.
- Share three associations.
- Discuss: stereotype or reality?



kiwi bird



rugby



Hobbiton

Vocabulary: five Kiwi values

Five values that shape Kiwi life.

01 **resourceful**

good at solving problems with what is available

02 **down-to-earth**

practical, sensible, and not pretentious

03 **ingenuity**

clever, original, and inventive

04 **mateship**

loyalty and friendship in difficult experiences

05 **hospitality**

friendly, generous, and welcoming to guests

Viewing task: New Zealand’s values

Watch “Our Country’s Values” and listen for at least three values.

- Write the value in English or Māori.
- Explain how it appears in everyday life.
- Be ready to share one example.



Four values to listen for

Manaakitanga

care for people

Kaitiakitanga

guardianship of the environment

Whanaungatanga

kinship and connection

Ingenuity

the “Number 8 Wire” mentality

Which value feels most unique to New Zealand? Why?



Number 8 Wire: solve the problem with what you have

Farmers historically used standard-gauge steel wire to repair fences, gates, and equipment when new parts were difficult to obtain.

Today the idea symbolizes ingenuity, resourcefulness, and a “can-do” attitude.

Question: why might this matter in a small, geographically isolated country?





Crisis scenario: 48 hours without outside help

You are locals in a New Zealand town of 5,000 people after a massive storm.

- The main road is flooded.
- The power is out.
- Fifty tourists are stuck.
- Emergency services cannot reach you for 48 hours.

Group challenge: choose three immediate actions

Decide what your group will do first. For every action, name the Kiwi value it uses.

01

Action 1: _____

value: _____

Ingenuity
use what is available.

02

Action 2: _____

value: _____

Care for people
hospitality and safety.

03

Action 3: _____

value: _____

Connection to place
use local knowledge and resources.

Dialogue of cultures

Compare your response with the response you might expect in your country.

New Zealand

Why are New Zealanders associated with a “can-do” attitude?

Your country

How might people in your country react to the same crisis?

Compare

Which response would be most effective — and why?